

Passages - Crito

SOCRATES: Honestly, Crito! Why should we care so much about what most people believe? The best people, who are the ones we have to worry about, will realise that things were done in the way they actually were done.

Don't you think it a sound principle that we should not value all human opinions equally?

Shouldn't we value some highly, but not others? And the same with the people who hold the opinions. We shouldn't value all of them. We should value some, but not others.

The most important thing is not to live, but to live a good life

Those who care for their city will look at you with suspicion, believing you to be a destroyer of the laws. You will also reinforce the opinion of the jury about you. They will decide they did reach the right verdict. After all, there's a strong presumption that a man who destroys the laws will be a destructive influence on people who are young and foolish.

'Oh, of course! You want to remain alive for your children's sake, so you can bring them up and educate them? By taking them to Thessaly? Is that any way to bring them up and educate them, turning them into foreigners, so you can give them that privilege as well? If you don't do that, if they are brought up here, will they be any better brought up and educated because you are alive and separated from them? Your friends are going to look after them. Will they look after them if you go and live

in Thessaly, and not look after them if you go to Hades? If those who claim to be your friends are worth anything at all, of course they'll look after them.

When you come to the next world, will it be better for you there. As it is you are going there - if you do go - as one wronged. Not by us. the laws, but by men. If on the other hand you depart after so shamefully returning wrong for wrong, and injury for injury, breaking your own agreement and contract with us, and injuring those whom above all you should not have injured - yourself, your friends, your country and us - then we shall be angry with you while you are alive, and in the next world our brothers, the laws in Hades, will not receive you kindly, since they will know that you tried, to the best of your ability, to destroy us.